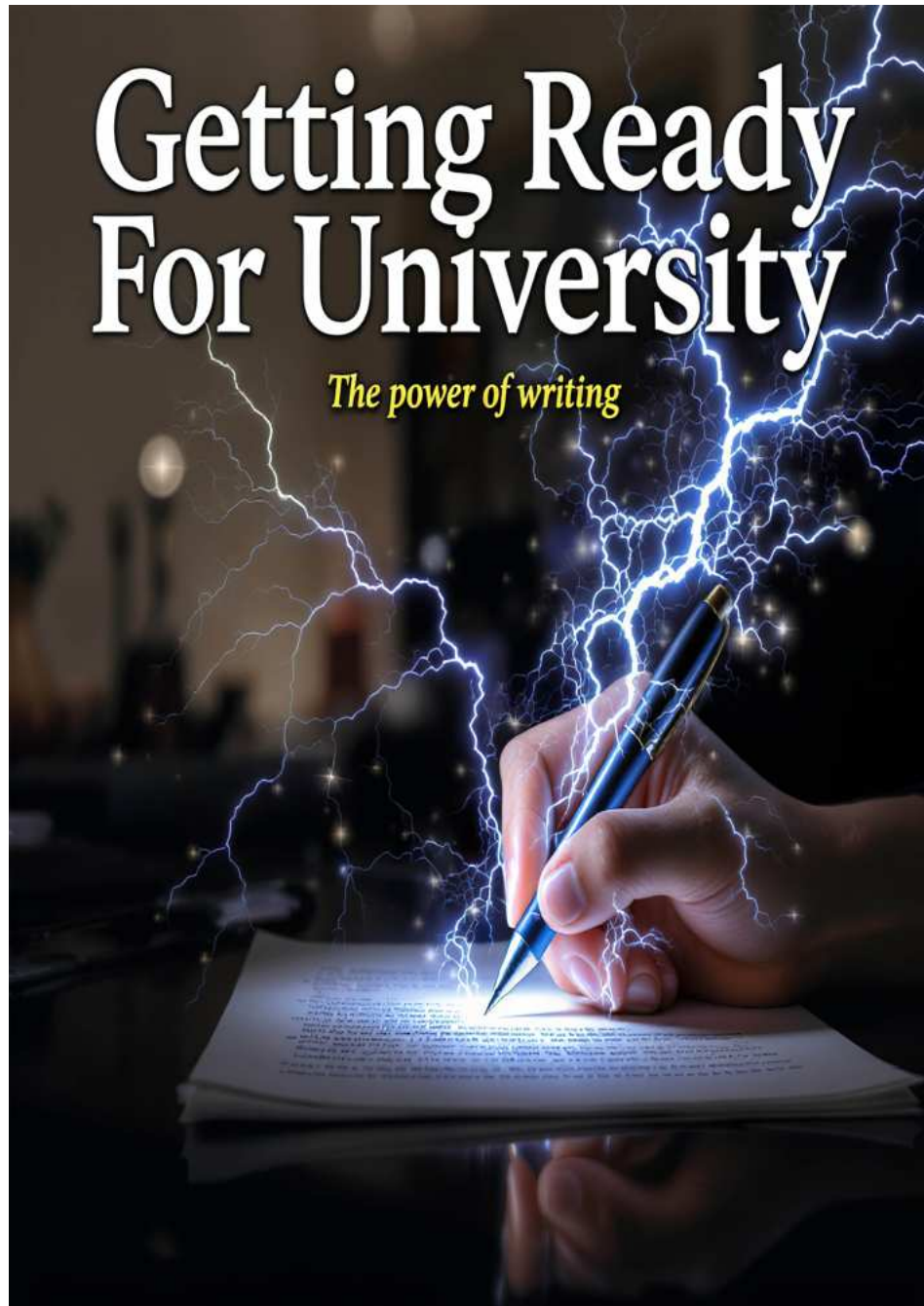




Getting ready for university

Course: Grade 11-12 ESL Academic Writing

Core Philosophy: Writing as Organised Thinking

Tools Integrated: DeepSeek, Quillbot, Notion

1. Syllabus Course Overview & Philosophy

1.1 The Core Belief: Writing as Organized Thinking

This course is founded on a single, powerful reframing: **Academic writing is not merely a skill to be learned; it is the physical architecture of thought.** We move beyond teaching "how to write an essay" to teaching "how to build a compelling argument," "how to deconstruct a complex problem," and "how to Synthesise information into new knowledge." The essay is simply the vehicle for this higher-order thinking.

1.2 Key Pedagogical Principles

1. **Metacognition Over Memorization:** Students are consistently asked to reflect on *why* they are making certain rhetorical choices. This builds self-aware, adaptable writers.
2. **Visual Scaffolding:** Complex processes are made concrete through flowcharts, diagrams, and mind maps (e.g., The Master Flowchart, The PEEL Model, The RADAR Checklist). These visuals provide a consistent framework that reduces cognitive load for ESL learners.
3. **Mastery Learning:** The course progresses logically from the smallest unit of meaning (the paragraph) to increasingly complex forms (the essay, the research proposal). Each step builds on the last.
4. **AI as a Collaborative Tool:** AI is integrated ethically and transparently. It is presented as a:
 - **Brainstorming Partner:** To overcome the blank page and generate ideas.
 - **Research Assistant:** To quickly grasp the basics of a topic and find sources.
 - **Editorial Helper:** To check grammar and suggest alternative phrasing.
 - **Critical thinking is always applied to AI output;** students must evaluate, refine, and take ownership of all ideas.

1.3 Meeting the Needs of the B2 ESL Learner

This course is tailored for learners who can communicate with fluency but may struggle with the specific rhetorical and grammatical nuances of academic discourse. Our strategy is to:

- **Make the implicit explicit:** Clearly explain cultural and academic conventions that native speakers often absorb unconsciously.
- **Focus on precision:** Target advanced grammar pain points (article usage, complex sentence structures, hedging language) through dedicated mini-lessons within the writing workshop context.
- **Leverage L1:** Encourage students to think and brainstorm in their first language before translating and refining their ideas in English, reducing the cognitive burden during the idea-generation phase.

2. Scope & Sequence

The 25-chapter course is divided into three logical parts, mirroring the writing process itself: **Foundation, Application, and Mastery.**

Chapter	Title	Key Content	Key Visual / Tool
Part I: The Foundation - Core Skills (Chapters 1-7)			
1	The Power of Thinking on Paper	Course philosophy, diagnostic, AI tool intro	Master Flowchart
2	The Power of a Single Paragraph	PEEL method, paragraph workshops	PEEL Diagram
3	The Power of a Question	Epistemology, question types	Question Funnel
4	The Power of Sound Logic I	Faulty Logic: Generalisations, Loaded Words	Fallacy Flashcards
5	The Power of Sound Logic II & RADAR	Slippery Slope, Either/Or, RADAR method	RADAR Checklist
6	The Thesis: The Engine of All Essays	Crafting theses for different essay types	Thesis Templates

Chapter	Title	Key Content	Key Visual / Tool
7	Research & Note-Taking for Synthesis	Database search, Cornell method, annotated bib	Synthesis Matrix
Part II: The Workshop - Application (Chapters 8-19)			
8	The Argumentative Essay	Full deep dive: outline, draft, review, final	Argument Outline
9	The Comparative Essay	Block vs. Point-by-Point structures	Comparison Diagrams
10	The Analytical Essay	Moving beyond summary to analysis	Analysis Ladder
11	The Problem-Solution Essay	Defining problems, evaluating solutions	Problem-Solution Outline
12	The Reflective Essay	Metacognition, language of reflection	Reflection Model
13	Advanced Research Techniques	Boolean operators, citation chaining	Research Flowchart
14	Writing with Style	Concision, clarity, strong verbs	Editing Checklist
15	Introductions & Conclusions	The funnel, beyond summary	Intro/Conclusion Map
16	The Literature Review	Synthesis, not summary	Synthesis Matrix
17	The Research Proposal	Question, Lit Review, Methodology	Proposal Template
18	The "They Say / I Say" Model	Entering academic conversations	They Say/I Say Templates
19	Discipline-Specific Writing	Conventions across fields	Discipline Samples
Part III: Mastery & Look Ahead (Chapters 20-25)			
20	Capstone Project Launch	Project choice, proposal	Capstone Proposal
21	Capstone Work I	Research & drafting workshop	N/A
22	Capstone Work II	Peer review, revision workshop	Peer Review Rubric
23	Capstone Work III	Editing, polishing, formatting	Final Checklist
24	Presentation Skills	Presenting research findings	Presentation Rubric
25	Course Wrap-up & Future-Proofing	Portfolio, reflection, uni prep	Portfolio Guide

This concludes the foundational part of the Teacher's Guide. The next step would be to populate the guide with the detailed lesson plans for **Chapter 1**, following the structure established in the Introduction.

Part 1: The Foundation - Core Skills (Lessons 1-10) 第一部分：基础 - 核心技能

Lesson 周	Chapter 章节	Key Content 主要内容	Assessments 评估
1	1. The Power of Thinking on Paper 写作的力量	Course philosophy, diagnostic essay, AI tools	Diagnostic Essay 诊断性作文
2	2. The Power of a Single Paragraph 段落的力量	PEEL method, paragraph workshops	PEEL Paragraph PEEL段落写作
3	3. The Power of a Question 提问的力量	Epistemology, question types	Research Questions 研究问题
4	4-5. Sound Logic & RADAR 逻辑与RADAR	Logical fallacies, source evaluation	Fallacy Identification 逻辑谬误识别
5	6. The Thesis Engine 论点引擎	Thesis types across essay formats	Thesis Workshop 论点工作坊
6	7. Research & Synthesis 研究与综合	Database research, Cornell notes	Annotated Bib Entry 注释书目条目
7	7. AI Research Integration AI研究整合	Using AI for research summarisation	Source Synthesis 文献综合

Lesson 周	Chapter 章节	Key Content 主要内容	Assessments 评估
8-9	8. Argumentative Essay Deep Dive 议论文深度研究	Full essay process: outline to final	Argumentative Essay 议论文
10	Academic Integrity 学术诚信	Citation, plagiarism, ethics	Citation Quiz 引用测验

Part 2: The Architect's Workshop (Lessons 11-20) 第二部分：建筑师工作坊

Lesson 周	Unit 单元	Key Content 主要内容	Assessments 评估
11-13	Comparative Essay 比较论文	Block vs. point-by-point structures	Comparative Essay 比较论文
14-15	Analytical Essay 分析论文	Analysis vs. summary, coding data	Analytical Essay 分析论文
16-17	Problem-Solution Essay 问题解决论文	Defining problems, evaluating solutions	Problem-Solution Essay 问题解决论文
18-20	Essay Exam & Review 论文考试与复习	Timed writing, exam strategies	Timed Essay 限时论文

Part 3: The Master Builder (Lessons 21-36) 第三部分：大师建造者

Lesson 周	Chapter 章节	Key Content 主要内容	Assessments 评估
21	Literature Review 文献综述	Synthesis vs. summary, thematic organization	Lit Review Outline 文献综述大纲
22	Research Proposal 研究计划	Methodology, significance, proposal writing	Research Proposal 研究计划
23	They Say/I Say Model 学术对话模式	Entering academic conversations	Dialogue Exercise 对话练习
24	Discipline-Specific Writing 学科特定写作	Field-specific conventions, citation styles	Discipline Research 学科研究
25-28	Capstone Project 顶点项目	Track 1: Research Paper (2500 words) Track 2: Portfolio & Reflection	Capstone Work 顶点项目工作
29	Presentations 展示汇报	Presenting research findings	Final Presentation 最终展示
30-33	Portfolio Development 作品集开发	Curating work, reflective writing	Final Portfolio 最终作品集
34-36	Wrap-up & University Prep 总结与大学准备	Transferable skills, future planning	Reflection Essay 反思论文

3. Learning Objectives 学习目标

Upon successful completion, students will be able to:
成功完成本课程后，学生将能够：

- **Demonstrate** 展示 mastery of four core academic skills: comprehension, analysis, synthesis, and argument
- **Adapt** 适应 writing style and structure for different disciplinary conventions
- **Conduct** 进行 ethical research using both traditional and AI-assisted methods
- **Produce** 创作 multiple university-level essay types including argumentative, comparative, analytical, and problem-solution
- **Create** 创建 sophisticated academic work: literature reviews, research proposals, and capstone projects
- **Present** 展示 research findings effectively in oral and written formats
- **Reflect** 反思 on their growth as writers and articulate transferable skills for university success

4. Policies 课程政策

- **Academic Integrity 学术诚信**：All work must be original with proper citation. AI may be used as a research assistant but not as a ghostwriter. All AI use must be documented.
- **Writing Process 写作过程**：We Emphasise drafting, peer review, and revision. Multiple drafts are required for major assignments.
- **Late Work 迟交作业**：Major assignments lose 10% per school day late. Communicate challenges in advance.
- **Classroom Community 课堂社区**：We build a supportive writing community where risk-taking and constructive feedback are valued.

5. Course Philosophy 课程理念

This course operates on the principle that **writing is thinking made visible**. We don't just write to demonstrate what we know; we write to discover what we think. The different essay types are simply different frameworks for organising thought. This approach ensures that students are prepared not just for specific assignments, but for any intellectual challenge they encounter in university and beyond.

本课程基于“写作是思维的可视化”这一理念。我们写作不仅是为了展示已知，更是为了探索未知。不同类型的论文只是组织思维的不同框架。这种方法确保学生不仅为特定作业做好准备，更为大学及以后遇到的任何智力挑战做好准备。

This syllabus represents our commitment to preparing students for university success. Modifications may be made to better serve student learning needs. 本大纲体现了我们为学生大学成功做好准备的承诺。可能会进行调整以更好地满足学生的学习需求。

This syllabus is subject to change with advance notice. 本大纲如有变更，将提前通知。

The goal is not just to teach essays, but to teach **writing as a tool for learning and thinking** across disciplines. Every university essay type is a variation on the core skills of:

1. **Comprehension** (Understanding a topic/text/data)
2. **Analysis** (Breaking it down and examining the parts)
3. **Synthesis** (Connecting ideas from multiple sources)
4. **Argument** (Forming a unique, evidence-based perspective)

The different essay types simply ask for a different balance of these skills. This integrated approach is powerful and prepares students for any writing task they encounter.

6. Summary of Key Objectives:

1. **Integrated Essay Types**: Students practice four core types (Argumentative, Comparative, Analytical, Problem-Solution), showing how skills transfer.
2. **Explicit University Genres**: Introduces the Literature Review and Research Proposal, which are fundamental to undergraduate work.
3. **"They Say / I Say" Model**: Teaches the crucial skill of writing within an existing academic conversation, which is the heart of university-level writing.
4. **Timed Essay Practice**: Prepares students for the reality of exam conditions.
5. **Discipline Awareness**: Helps students see that writing is not one-size-fits-all and encourages them to investigate the norms of their chosen field.
6. **Capstone Choice**: Allows for differentiation and personalization based on student interest and confidence.

7. The Visual System Plan

We will develop three core master visuals that are constantly referenced and built upon:

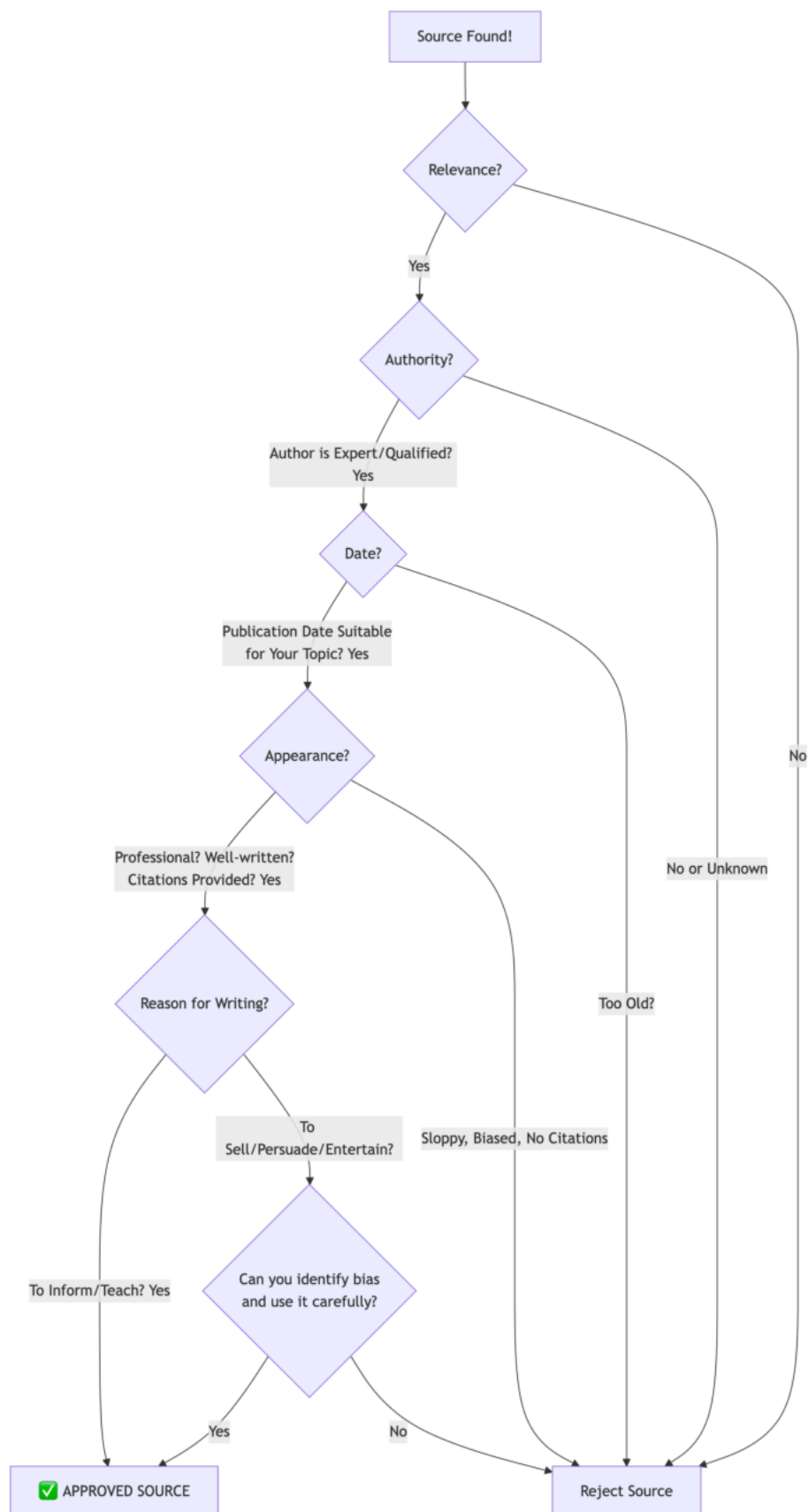
• Prove your Point.	• This is the most important part!	
• A fact, quote, statistic, or example from a source.	• "This shows that..."	
• Introduce & cite it.	• Connect the Evidence back to your Point and your overall Thesis.	
	• Do not assume the reader makes the connection for you.	
+-----+		
[L] LINK		
• Link to the next paragraph or back to the thesis.		
• "This not only shows X, but also introduces Y..."		
• Creates flow and cohesion.		
+-----+		

How to use it: Students can use this as a checklist for every body paragraph. They can literally write their paragraph in the boxes. Peer reviews can focus on whether each component is present and strong.

3. The RADAR Evaluation Checklist

Introduced in **Lesson 5**, this turns the RADAR concept into an actionable checklist students can use for every source they find.

How to use it: Students run every website and article through this mental (or physical) flowchart before deciding to use it. This makes source evaluation a concrete habit rather than an abstract idea.



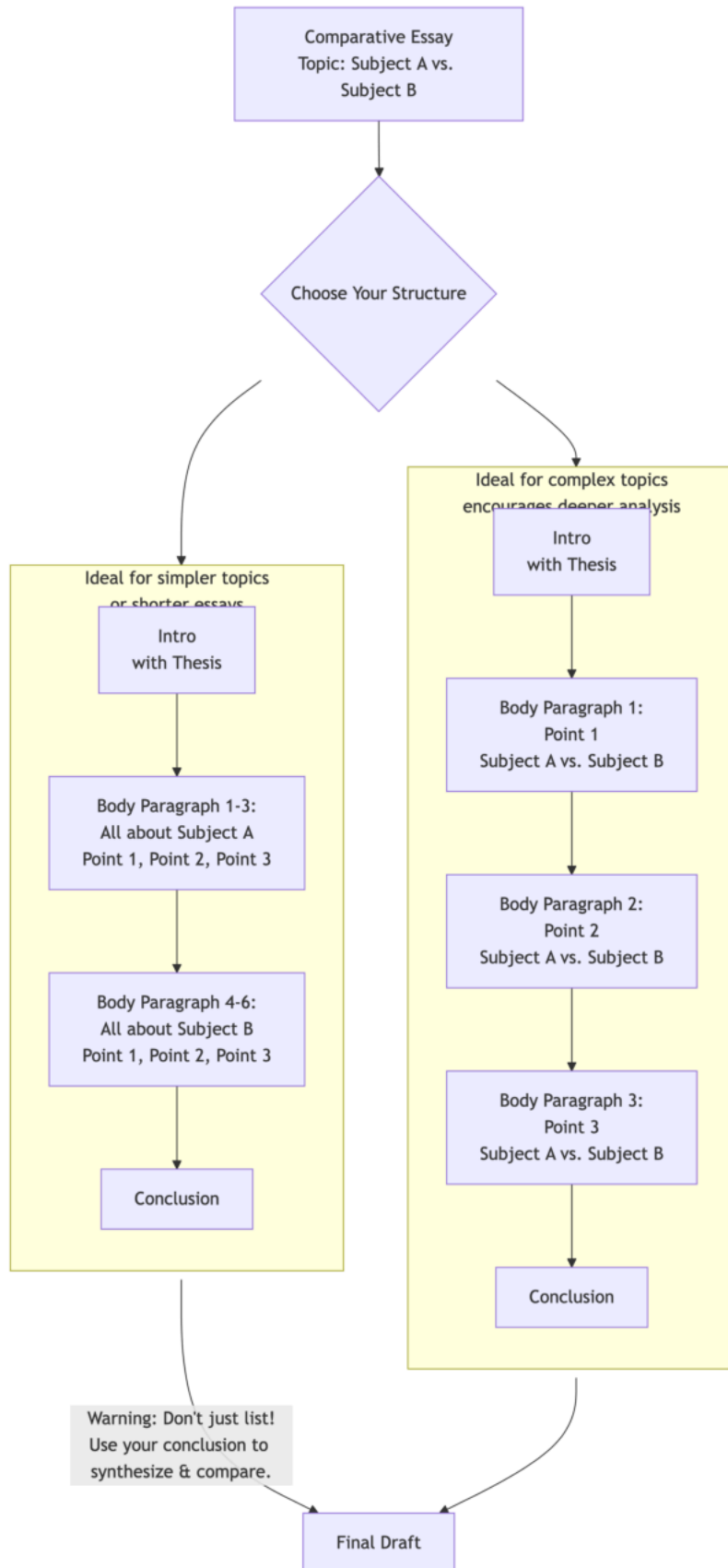
4. Integration into the Course Outline:

- **Lesson 1:** Introduce the **Master Flowchart**. Explain that the entire course is about mastering each step.
- **Lesson 2:** Introduce the **PEEL Diagram**. All paragraph writing workshops use this template.
- **Lesson 5:** Introduce the **RADAR Checklist**. The source evaluation lab is a practical exercise using it.
- **Lesson 14 (Comparative Essay):** Introduce a **Block vs. Point-by-Point** structure diagram.
- **Lesson 16 (Analytical Essay):** Introduce an **Analysis Pyramid** (Description → Analysis → Significance).
- **Lesson 21 (Literature Review):** Introduce a **Synthesis Matrix** (A grid to track sources and themes).

This visual system provides a consistent, clear, and engaging framework for students. It makes the invisible process of writing visible and manageable, which is especially powerful for ESL students. I am ready to develop these specific diagrams for each Lesson.

5. Lesson 14: Comparative Essay Structures

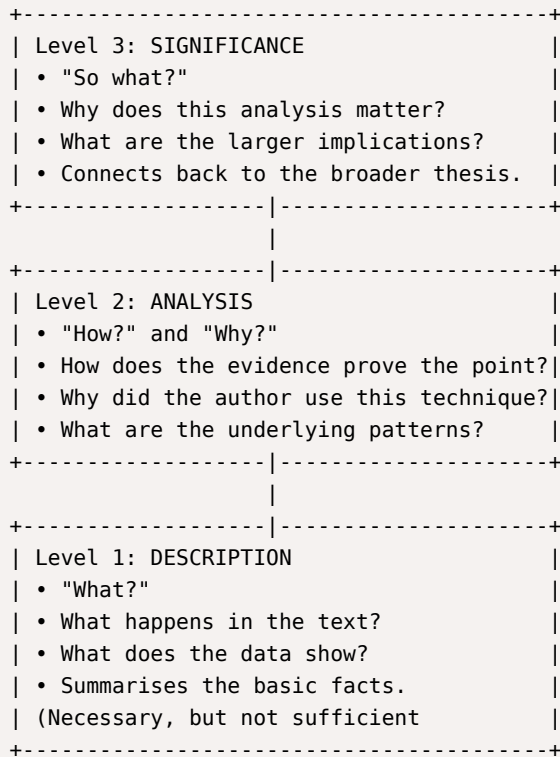
This diagram helps students choose and visualise the two main ways to structure a comparative essay.



6. Lesson 16: The Analysis Pyramid

This visual moves students beyond summary to real analysis by showing a hierarchy of thinking.

text



Teacher's Note: Emphasise that a strong analytical essay spends most of its time in Levels 2 and 3. Level 1 is only used to briefly set up the analysis.

Lesson 21: The Synthesis Matrix (Literature Review)

This is a practical tool to help students organise their research and see connections between sources, which is the heart of a literature review.

Topic: The Impact of Social Media on Adolescent Mental Health

Research Themes → Sources ↓	Theme 1: Anxiety & Depression	Theme 2: Social Comparison	Theme 3: Fear of Missing Out (FoMO)	Gaps / My Ideas
Smith (2022) <i>"Digital Anxiety"</i>	Finds strong correlation between usage time and anxiety scores.	Briefly mentions comparison as a factor.	Main finding: Identifies FoMO as a primary driver.	Method only surveys teens aged 16-18.
Chen & Li (2023) <i>"Comparative Cultures"</i>	No significant link found.	Main finding: Develops a new scale for measuring social comparison online.	Links social comparison to FoMO.	Sample group was university students.
Ibrahim (2021) <i>"The FoMO Phenomenon"</i>	argues anxiety is a result of FoMO, not general usage.	Doesn't address.	Main finding: Defines 3 types of FoMO.	Qualitative study, small sample size.
My Synthesis	Sources disagree. Is anxiety from time spent (Smith) or from FoMO (Ibrahim)?	Agreement: Chen and Ibrahim both see this as key.	Agreement: All three sources see this as a crucial area.	Gap: Need more research on younger teens. My thesis will argue that...

How to Use It:

1. **Before you write:** Use the matrix to take notes from each source.
 2. **Find connections:** Look for columns (themes) where multiple sources agree, disagree, or complement each other.
 3. **Find gaps:** The "Gaps / My Ideas" column is where their own critical voice and thesis emerge.
 4. **Write your review:** Structure the review by **theme** (the columns) instead of by **source** (the rows). This is the key to synthesis.
-

Grading and Assessments

The CEFR (Common European Framework of Reference) grading system is **a standard that uses six levels to describe language proficiency: A1, A2, B1, B2, C1, and C2**. These levels are grouped into three broad categories: **Basic User** (A1-A2), **Independent User** (B1-B2), and **Proficient User** (C1-C2). Each level has specific "can-do" statements that describe what a language learner can do in terms of skills like listening, reading, writing, and speaking.

Basic User

- **A1 (Beginner):** Can understand and use familiar everyday expressions and very basic phrases to satisfy simple needs.
- **A2 (Elementary):** Can communicate in simple and routine tasks, and can describe in simple terms aspects of their background and immediate environment.

Independent User

- **B1 (Intermediate):** Can understand the main points on familiar matters and can deal with most situations likely to arise whilst traveling. Can produce simple connected text on familiar topics.
- **B2 (Upper-Intermediate):** Can understand the main ideas of complex text on both concrete and abstract topics. Can interact with a degree of fluency and spontaneity, and can produce clear, detailed text on a wide range of subjects.

Proficient User

- **C1 (Advanced):** Can understand a wide range of demanding, longer texts, and recognize implicit meaning. Can express oneself fluently and spontaneously without much obvious searching for expressions.
- **C2 (Proficiency):** Can understand with ease virtually everything heard or read. Can summarise information from different spoken and written sources, reconstructing arguments and accounts in a coherent presentation.

Course Grading is separated into:

Essays - 50%

Coursework - 20%

Homework 20%

Class Participation and Attendance 10%

How do I understand my score?

Grading Matrix: Academic Writing (Nonfiction) - G12

This matrix aligns your numerical scores with the corresponding CEFR level descriptors for writing, reflecting the skills expected in a Grade 12 Academic Nonfiction course.

Final Grade (%)	CEFR Level	CEFR Descriptor (Applied to Academic Nonfiction Writing)
90 - 100	C2	Mastery: Writing is sophisticated, precise, and effortlessly controlled. The student can Synthesise complex information from various sources into a coherent, well-structured, and compelling argument. The prose is not only error-free but also stylistically advanced and engaging.
80 - 89	C1	Advanced: Writing is fluent and complex. The student can tackle demanding nonfiction topics, develop a clear thesis, and structure arguments logically. They use a wide range of vocabulary and complex grammatical structures with minimal errors. The writing is persuasive and appropriate for an academic audience.
70 - 79	B2	Upper-Intermediate: Writing is clear and detailed on a wide range of subjects. The student can present a viewpoint and develop an argument with supporting reasons and examples. While generally accurate, there may be occasional errors, especially when attempting more complex sentences. The writing is effective but may lack the fluency and sophistication of higher levels.
60 - 69	B1	Intermediate: Writing is simple but connected. The student can convey the main points on a familiar topic and write straightforward paragraphs. However, vocabulary is limited, sentences are often simple, and there are noticeable errors in grammar and word choice that can occasionally impede clarity. The argument may be present but underdeveloped.
50 - 59	A2	Elementary: Writing is basic and routine. The student can use a series of simple phrases and sentences to describe personal experiences or very concrete topics. There is little to no evidence of argumentation, and the structure is weak. Errors are frequent and significantly hinder comprehension.
0 - 49	A1	Beginner: Writing is limited to isolated words, memorized phrases, and very simple sentences. The text does not meet the basic requirements of the assignment and is difficult to understand.

Guide to Calculating Your Final Grade

Your final grade is a weighted average of four components. Here is how to calculate it and interpret the result.

1. Weighting of Components

Component	Weight	Example Score (out of)	Calculation
Essays	50%	Score / 50	$(\text{Essay Score} / 50) * 0.50$
Coursework	20%	Score / 100	$(\text{Coursework Score} / 100) * 0.20$
Homework	20%	Score / 100	$(\text{Homework Score} / 100) * 0.20$
Class Participation	10%	Score / 10	$(\text{Participation Score} / 10) * 0.10$

2. Step-by-Step Calculation & CEFR Conversion

Let's use your example and build a full student profile.

Step 1: Convert each component to its weighted percentage.